PROJECT CHARTER

LITPATH AI: SMART PATHFINDER FOR THESES AND DISSERTATIONS

ASIA PACIFIC COLLEGE
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APRIL 1, 2026

PROJECT CHARTER

This Charter formally authorizes the LitPath AI Project to design and develop a standalone AI-powered web application that provides intelligent academic thesis and dissertation search capabilities for the DOST-STII Library. A project plan will be developed and submitted to the Project Sponsor for approval. All resources will be assigned by the Project Sponsor, Khasian Eunice Romulo, Science Research Specialist II / Unit Head of Digital Information and Processing Delivery Unit.

The purpose of the LitPath AI project is to improve the quality, efficiency, and relevance of research experiences in academic libraries, particularly within the DOST'S OPAC system. This project meets DOST-STII Library's need for a standalone AI-powered web application that addresses vague results and limited keyword matching through advanced AI techniques including vector embeddings and large language models. The system delivers semantic search results, intelligent summaries, and citation generation with faster query processing and result display compared to traditional library OPAC systems. The project deliverables shall include an AI-powered query engine, an in-text citation and bookmark feature, research history, follow-up questions, and an admin dashboard. The objectives of the LitPath AI project are to improve search result relevance and research efficiency for student researchers and library staff. High level risks include completing all features before the June–July 2026 deployment deadline. Success will be determined by the Project Sponsor once the system is deployed and usability testing confirms improved research outcomes.

The Project Manager, Tracie Tomon (Group Leader), is hereby authorized to interface with management as required, negotiate for resources, delegate responsibilities within the framework of the project, and communicate with all contractors and management to ensure successful and timely completion. The Project Manager is responsible for developing the project plan, monitoring schedule and scope, assigning tasks, overseeing system integration, testing, and documentation, and organizing final outputs for defense and presentation.

The project plan will be submitted and approved in accordance with the milestone schedule outlined below. Upon approval, resources will be assigned and development work will proceed in phases from planning and design through backend development, system integration, user testing, and final deployment. The Project Sponsor must approve any changes that may impact milestone dates. A detailed schedule will be maintained throughout the project lifecycle. The high-level milestone schedule is:

Milestone	Target Date	Status
Project Scoping	April 2025	Completed
Information Gathering	April 2025	Completed
Completion of Project Deliverables & Documentation	June 2025	Completed
Design Thinking Process (Stages 1–5)	Aug 2025	Completed

Core UI Development (System UI, Citation Generator, Bookmark)	Sep – Oct 2025	Completed
AI Search Engine, Generate Overview, Feedback Mechanism & Admin Dashboard	Oct 2025 – Jan 2026	Completed
Feature Refinement & Client Feedback Integration	Feb – Mar 2026	Completed
Continued Development & Performance Optimization (incl. codebase restructuring)	Mar – Apr 2026	In Progress
Proxmox Server Deployment & Internal Testing	Apr 2026	In Progress
Bug Fixes & Usability Testing	May – Jun 2026	Not Started
Final Deployment	Jun – Jul 2026	Not Started

LitPath AI initially did not require a formal budget, however, with the planned cloud deployment and the integration of AI/LLM services, operational costs are now anticipated. Expected costs include cloud hosting fees for the final production deployment in June–July 2026, as well as AI/LLM API usage costs incurred during development, testing, and live operation of the system. These costs are to be shouldered by DOST-STII as the primary client and sponsor of the project. A detailed cost breakdown will be finalized once the specific cloud infrastructure and AI/LLM services are confirmed with the client.

SPONSOR ACCEPTANCE

Approved by the Project Sponsor:

_____ Date: April 1, 2026

Khasian Eunice Romulo
Science Research Specialist II / Unit Head
(Digital Information and Processing Delivery Unit)